



Briefing on Large Language Models for Clinical Text Summarization

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Executive Summary

Current research into Large Language Models (LLMs) for clinical text summarization reveals a field characterized by high potential but significant scientific immaturity. The primary takeaway from recent literature is that while adapted LLMs can produce summaries that clinicians judge as comparable to or better than expert-written notes, standard automated metrics (such as ROUGE and BLEU) are insufficient for evaluating clinical readiness.



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- **Clinician Preference vs. Metrics:** Clinicians frequently favor LLM-generated summaries for coherence and usefulness even when automated scores are low.
- **The Power of Adaptation:** Performance is significantly enhanced through task-specific adaptation, particularly via "in-context

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